



IF I DO A WRONG CEO HIRE, I COULD BE BRINGING DOWN THE P&L AND DRAGGING DOWN SHARE PRICES A COUPLE OF NOTCHES”

SUSHANT DWIVEDY

Managing Director (India & the Philippines), SHL



WORKING PEOPLE SPEND 60% OF THEIR ACTIVE LIFE IN EMPLOYMENT. IF YOU’VE NEVER BEEN ABLE TO ABOUT IT SOCIALLY, IT’S SOMETHING TO THINK ABOUT”

ADITYA MISHRA

Director and CEO, CIEL HR Services

spotting a serious red flag. She prefers checking social media only when she sees merit in taking the candidature forward. Sterling, Sinha says, conducts checks only after the employee has accepted the offer and consented to background verification and social media screening. “At the interview stage, there is no explicit permission or implied clearance,” he says.

Arun S. Prabhu, Partner and Head of Technology, Media, Telecommunications practice at law firm Cyril Amarchand Mangaldas, says it is not illegal when carried out with informed consent, which is what most

reputed organisations do. Even if the consent form doesn’t explicitly say so, as long as the information is not in a private profile, it can be argued that the information which was made publicly available by the candidate can be reviewed, he says. “But there are people who do this in a more intrusive way by checking private profiles or pages, or looking at material which, in its context, was shared with a reasonable expectation of privacy. This is a much greyer area.”

As Luthra points out, it takes just one candidate to get irked by what you know about them and it will be all over social media. “That’s the end of it.”

It goes back to how Ahuja handled the situation with the recruiter who had a problem with the Instagram account of a prospective employee. “We had to escalate it and say, ‘You cannot bring these biases when you are recruiting someone’.” **BT**

LINKEDIN AND TWITTER ARE CHECKED THE MOST. BUT FACEBOOK AND INSTAGRAM ARE NOT ENTIRELY RULED OUT. SOME ALSO LOOK AT PINTEREST, YOUTUBE AND NEWS SOURCES. STILL OTHERS PREFER GITHUB, QUORA, CITEHR AND OTHER DOMAIN-EXPERTISE SITES